

Eric Askelson, ASA, MAAA

Director Actuarial | Protective Life | Birmingham, Alabama

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Professional Summary

Actuary with 12+ years of experience at Protective Life, progressing from actuarial student to Director. Combines deep technical expertise in valuation and financial reporting with a passion for automation, process improvement, and developing talent. Known for building scalable training programs and introducing modern development practices to actuarial workflows.

Experience

Protective Life Corporation

Birmingham, Alabama | June 2013 – Present

Universal Life Valuation | 2021 – Present | Director Actuarial

Led subset of UL valuation team while maintaining hands-on technical contributions. Managed team of 3–5 including actuarial students and technical experts.

- **Financial Analysis:** Expanded experience measurement tool and took prominent role in explaining UL earnings drivers to leadership
- **LDTI Implementation:** Led Universal Life LDTI implementation for valuation - built model changes, developed testing framework, coordinated cross-functional team for reporting readiness
- **Training Program:** Created ~20-session annual training curriculum covering GAAP/Stat calculations, Excel, SQL, PowerQuery, Git, and PolySystems; evolved delivery model so rotating students progress from attendee to presenter; expanded to monthly technical training sessions for full department (roughly 90 people)
- **People Development:** Focused on career development through 1:1 mentoring across subteam and broader department

Traditional Life Valuation | 2018 – 2020 | Actuarial Assistant III

Extended technical innovations to new product line while deepening financial reporting expertise.

- **Version Control Evangelist:** Extended Git version control implementation to Traditional Life PolySystems models
- **Report Automation:** Built PowerQuery dashboard tracking model and assumption update impacts
- **Traditional Life Financial Analysis:** Developed GAAP and Statutory financial impact explanations for quarterly reporting

Universal Life Valuation | 2013 – 2018 | Actuarial Assistant II

Built foundational actuarial skills while driving automation and process improvement initiatives.

- **Foundational Skills:** Developed deep expertise in reinsurance modeling, accounting, and Legacy GAAP (FAS97), as well as SQL, Excel, and VBA
- **SQL True-Up Process:** Designed and built novel SQL process to ingest data from general ledger and PolySystems valuation software, automating FAS97 true-up calculations
- **Experience Measurement:** Implemented variance analysis tool decomposing experience into mortality, non-death terminations, and other drivers - enabled clear communication of results to leadership

- **Version Control Pioneer:** Researched and implemented Git for actuarial model change tracking; developed gitignore configurations, clean/smudge filters, best-practice documentation, and training program for PolySystems users

University of Alabama at Birmingham

Birmingham, Alabama

Mathematics Department | Aug 2012 – May 2013 | Teaching Assistant

- Tutored students in Algebra, Calculus, Differential Equations, Linear Algebra, and Abstract Algebra
- Proctored examinations for undergraduate mathematics courses

Education

Master of Science in Mathematics

University of Alabama at Birmingham | 2012 – 2013 GPA: 3.9 | Specialization: Analysis, Probability & Statistics

Bachelor of Science in Mathematics

University of Alabama at Birmingham | 2008 – 2012 GPA: 4.0 | Summa Cum Laude | Honors in Mathematics | Presidential Honors

Technical Skills

Languages & Tools: SQL, PowerQuery, Power BI, Excel/VBA, Git **Actuarial Platforms:** PolySystems

Areas of Expertise: Life insurance valuation, LDIT, FAS97, reinsurance modeling, experience analysis, process automation

Last updated: December 2025